

World War 1

The Great War







HEIR TO AUSTRIAN THRONE ASSASSINATED; WIFE BY HIS SIDE ALSO SHOT TO DEATH; EARLIER ATTEMPT ON THEIR LIVES FAILED

HEIR TO THE AUSTRIAN THRONE AND HIS WIFE, VICTIMS OF ASSASSIN.



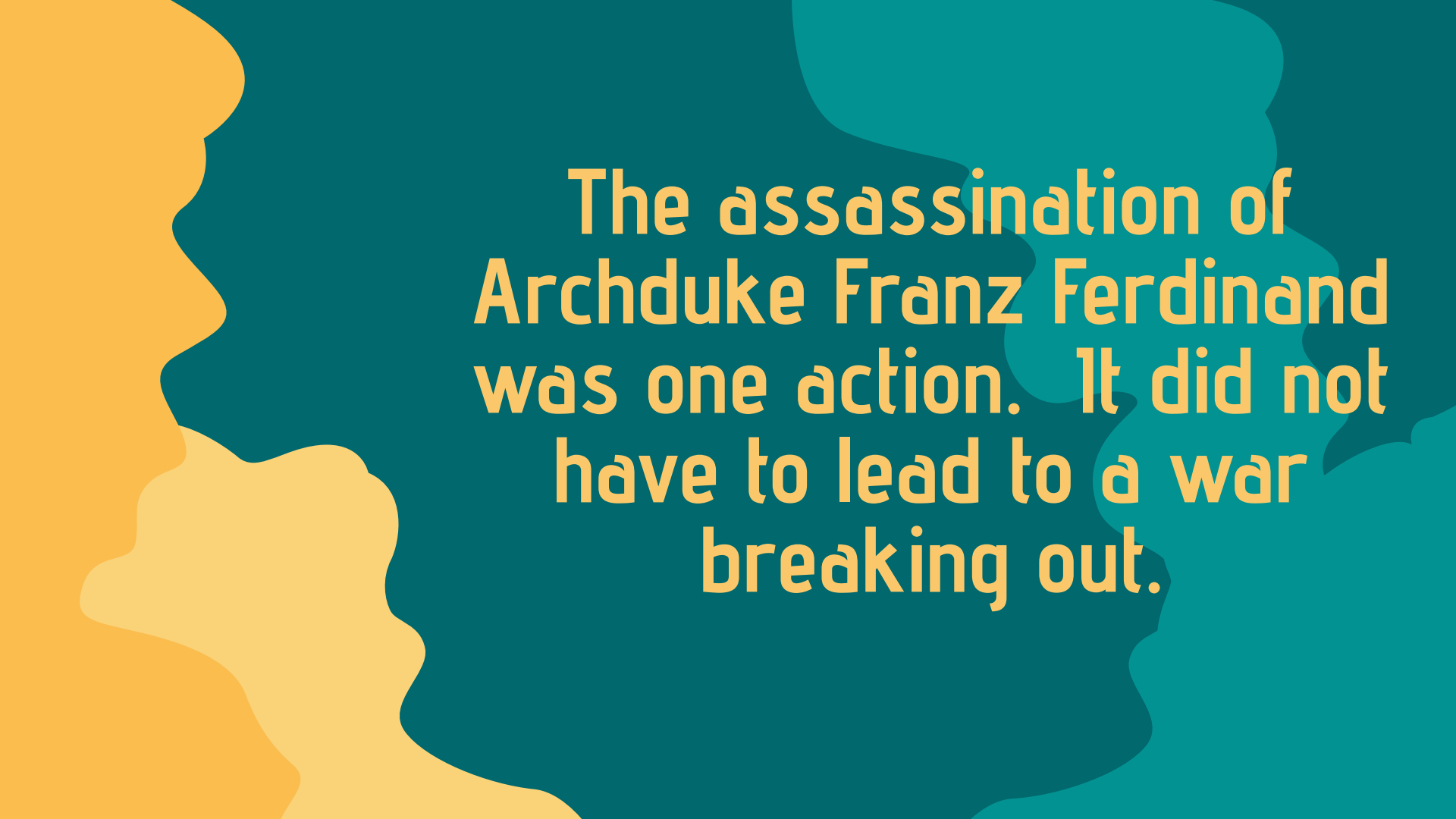
Francis Ferdinand, Nephew of Emperor Francis Joseph, Killed in Bosnian Capital an Hour After Warding Off Bomb Which Injures Score.

SLAYER A SERBIAN SOCIALIST

Volley from Revolver Hits Archduke and Duchess of Hohenburg as They Are Driving Together in Automobile in Town of Sarajevo—New Heir, Charles Joseph, 27 Years Old.

(By Cable to The Tribune.)
Sarajevo, Bosnia, June 28.—The Archduke Francis Ferdinand, heir to the dual monarchy of Austria-Hungary, and his morganatic wife, the Duchess of Hohenberg, were shot to death to-day in the main street of this, the Bosnian capital. Bullets from a magazine revolver in the hands of an eighteen-year-old youth killed the heir apparent and his wife, and thus completed the grim task a madman had unsuccessfully attempted only a few hours before by hurling a bomb at the royal automobile.

Another terrible chapter has thus been written into the tragic



The assassination of
Archduke Franz Ferdinand
was one action. It did not
have to lead to a war
breaking out.

Background Context

- Pre-war Europe is already a mess
 - Assassinations, violence, religious intolerance, anti-semitism, labor strikes, political upheaval, discontent
- Europe is still industrializing
- Nationalist sentiment means more than previously

Main Causes of The Great War

- Militarism
- Alliance System
- Nationalism
- Industrialization/Imperialism
- Assassination of the Archduke

Nationalism

- Self-determination based on language, ethnic origin, and politics
- Austria-Hungary had to deal with the most diverse groups
 - Serbia is the most aggressive and militant
 - Russia was pushing for Pan-Slavism
- Rise of the Young Turks against the Ottomans





Industrialization

- Rivalries between countries led to a desire to increase production and territorial expansion
- Industrialization leads to military advancing and stockpiling by major European powers

Imperialism

- Imperialism was leading to global violence and could be seen as a “training ground” for what was to come
- Battles occurred outside of Europe’s borders and included individuals from all around the world

Imperialism

- The British Empire took in India, South Africa, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, Hong Kong, parts of North Africa, islands in the Pacific and Caribbean and concessions in China.
- Russia ruled modern-day Poland, Finland, Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, the Ukraine, Georgia and several regions in central Asia, such as Kazakhstan. Russia also had colonial interests in East Asia, including a concession in China.
- France maintained colonies in modern-day Vietnam, Laos and Cambodia, areas of West Africa and India, small possessions in South America, and islands in the Pacific and Caribbean.
- Germany had seized control of modern-day Tanzania, Namibia and Cameroon in Africa, German New Guinea, some Pacific islands and an important concession in Shandong (China).
- Austria-Hungary possessed no colonies outside Europe but was an empire nonetheless, ruling over several different regions, ethnic and language groups. Among its regions were Bohemia, Moravia, Silesia, Galicia, Transylvania, the Tyrol and, after 1908, Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- Spain once possessed a large empire that included Cuba, the Philippines and large areas of South America – but by 1914 the Spanish were left with only tiny colonial territories in the Americas and north-west Africa.
- The United States was a relative newcomer to imperialism but by 1914 had gained control of the Philippines, Guam, American Samoa, Puerto Rico and several islands in the Pacific. Though later absorbed into the United States, both Alaska and the Hawaiian Islands might be considered colonial acquisitions.
- The Ottoman Empire was once the largest empire in the world, taking in eastern Europe, the Middle East and much of northern Africa. Ottoman territory had shrunk significantly but by 1914 the sultanate retained the heart of its old empire: modern-day Turkey, Egypt, Syria, Palestine, Armenia and Macedonia.
- Portugal in 1914 was the imperial ruler of modern-day Angola and Mozambique in Africa, Goa (India) and East Timor (Indonesia).
- Belgium was one of the smallest nations in Europe but still possessed a significant African colony (Belgian Congo), as well as a small concession in China.
- Holland had several small colonial possessions in South America (Dutch Guyana), Asia (Batavia, or modern-day Indonesia) and the Pacific.
- Italy by 1914 had moved into northern Africa, annexing modern-day Libya, Somalia and Eritrea. It also held a small concession in China.



Austro-Hungarian	French	Portuguese
Belgian	German	Russian
British	Italian	Spanish
Dutch	Ottoman	United States

Gray areas are not part of any empire



Militarism

- Creation of dreadnoughts
 - Production of dreadnoughts and other military technologies was seen as a way of maintaining employment levels
- Development of War Plans
 - France's Plan XVII and Germany's Schlieffen Plan
 - Attack at all costs
 - Do not get encircled, invade into France and fend off Russia
 - Debate over the validity or reality of these plans, but they end up being enacted





Assassination of the Archduke

- Balkan Wars in 1912 and 1913 over Ottoman lands led to tensions in Southern Europe and increased Nationalism
 - Serbia had claimed land and start moving towards becoming an independent nation
 - Serbia is issued ultimatum by Austrians in July 1914
- Young Turks are acting violently in Southern Europe
- Archduke Franz Ferdinand wants to build an absolute monarchy as heir to the Austrian-Hungary Throne
 - Is killed by Serbian Nationalist, Gavrilo Princip



Alliance Systems

Triple Alliance (Central Power)

- Germany and Austria-Hungary are first involved (1879)
- Italy joins after feeling threatened by France (1882)
- All have different goals
 - Italy not a fan of Ottomans while Germany likes them
 - Italy will leave in 1915

Triple Entente (The Allies)

- France and Britain want to curb Germany's growth (1904)
 - Germany had wanted to ally with Britain to defeat Southern Europe
- Russia enters into military pacts with France and England to protect themselves from Germany

Alliance Systems

- Austria tells Germany their initial plan is to swiftly attack Serbia and partition their land
 - Kaiser offers a “blank check” thinking there’s no way Russia will get involved
 - Assassination was June 28, 1914
- Austria issues Serbia a very harsh and very provocative ultimatum on July 23, 1914
 - Serbia shares with Russia who thinks this is all the doing of the Germans

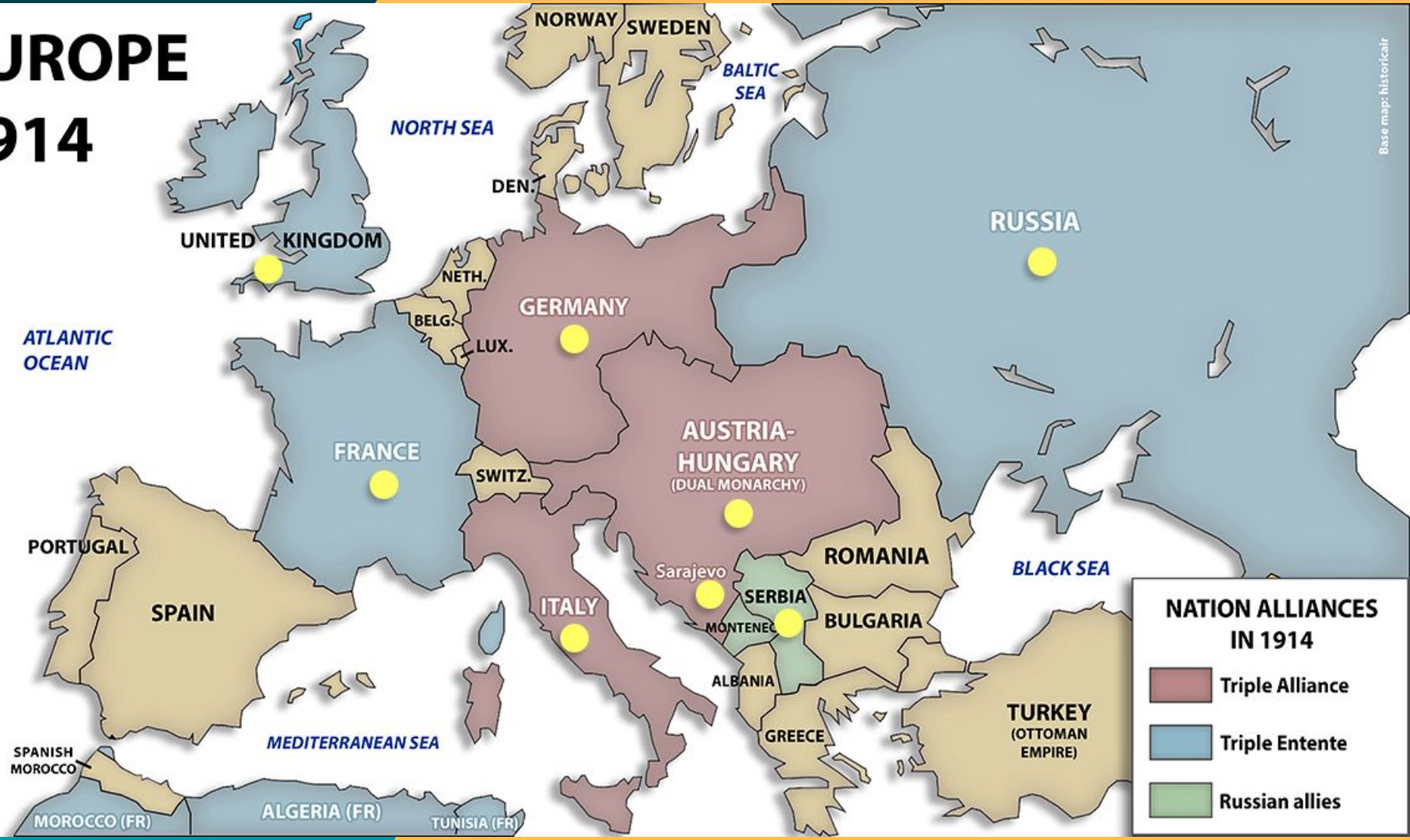
Alliance Systems

- Britain wants to remain out until they see what everyone else is doing
 - Becomes clear that Russia supports the Serbs, France supports Russia, Germany and Austria-Hungary are already close
- If we stay out, we are in a lose lose situation

The First Global Conflict



EUROPE 1914



Fighting the War

- Nations begin using all civilians as part of the war effort
- War engulfs every facet of society



Why a Global War?

1. European governments carried their local animosity towards each other into their global colonies
2. European governments needed bodies to fight and win the war
3. Desires and objectives of the different global empires created motivations

Major Events and Developments in the War

1914 and 1915

- September 1914 – Allies stop German advances into France
 - First Battle of the Marne
- February 1915 – Germany enacts a naval blockade of Great Britain
- April 1915 – Gallipoli Campaign Begins
- May 1915 – Germany sinks the HMS Lusitania, which kills Americans
- May 1915 – Italy declares war on Austria-Hungary after becoming fearful of expansion from Germany and Austria-Hungary

Major Events and Developments in the War

1916 and 1917

- February 1916 – Verdun Begins
- April 1916 – Battle of the Somme Begins
- December 1916 – Verdun Ends
 - 1 Million casualties between French and Germans
- January 1917 – Zimmerman Telegram intercepted by the United States
 - German and Mexican Military Alliance?
- April 1917 – US declares war on Germany
- December 1917 – Russia signs military armistice with Germany



Japan's Entry into the War

- Japan demands Germany gives up their colonial claims in China and surrounding areas
 - Enter the war after Germany refuses
- Japan issues China the “21 Demands”
 - Secret document that the Chinese share with the British
 - Tensions between Britain and Japan

The War Outside of Europe

- Arabs begin to revolt against the Ottomans in hopes of getting autonomy after the war
- Sykes-Picot Treaty between Britain, France, and Russia
 - Create Spheres of Influence in Middle East after the war





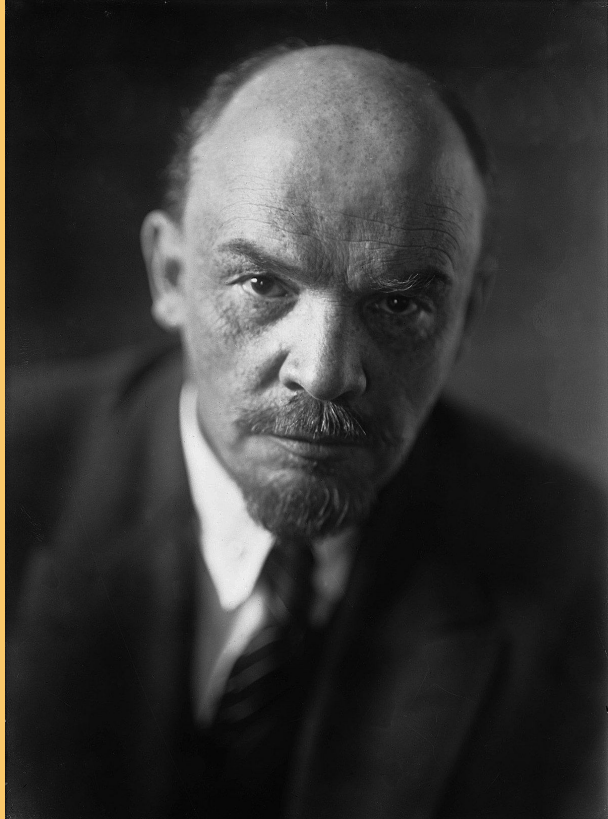
Russia's Exit from the War

Russia's Exit from the War (1917)

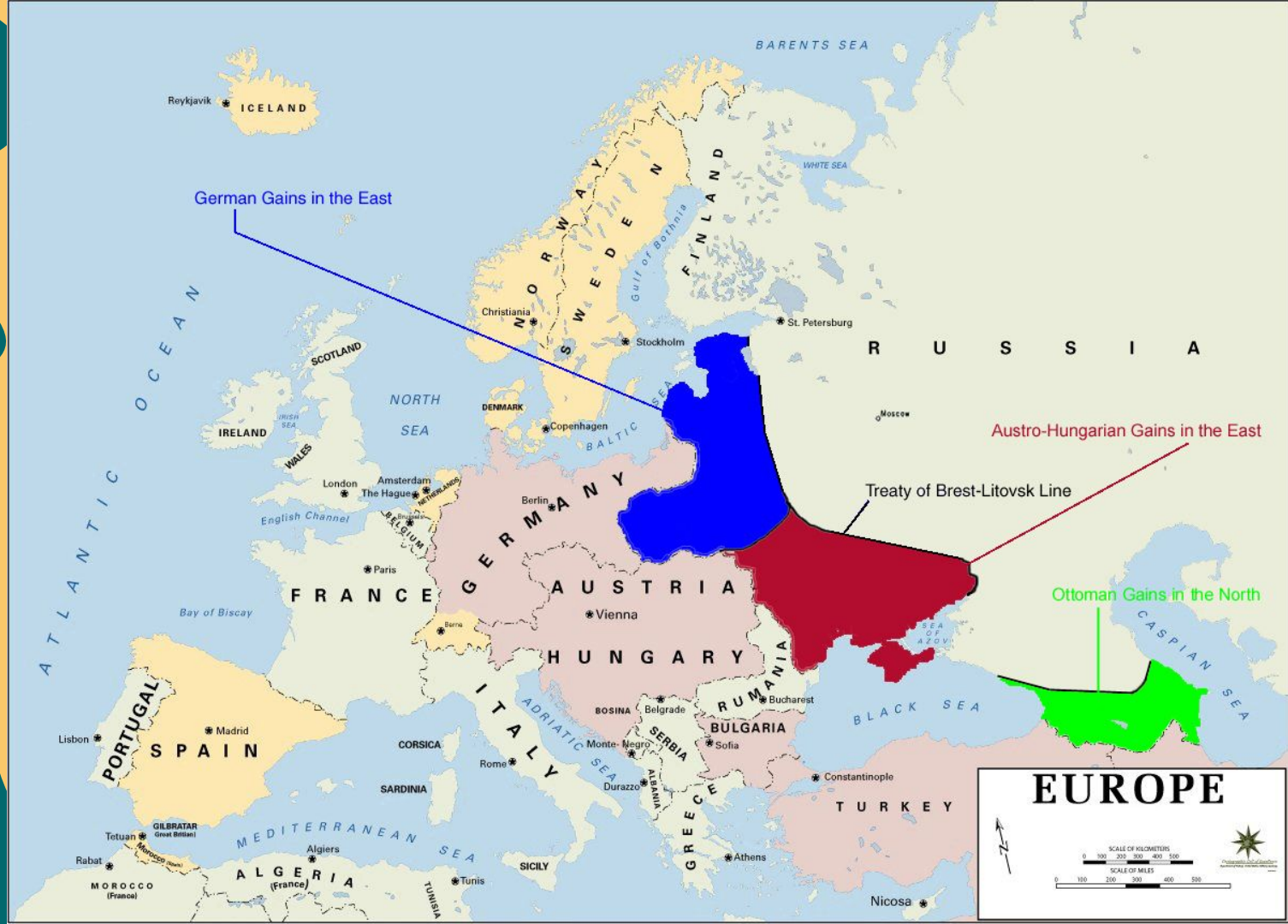
- Tensions were already bad under Tsar Nicholas II
- Tsar Nicholas II abdicates the throne
 - Romanov Dynasty collapses after 300 years



Russia's Exit from the War (1917)



- Protests throughout Russia lead to re-emergence of Socialist Party
 - Provisional Government vs. Petrograd Soviet (Socialists)
- Vladimir Lenin leads the Bolsheviks after returning from exile
 - “Peace, Land, and Bread”
- Sign the Treaty of Brest-Litovsk



US Entry into the War

The background features abstract, organic shapes. A large yellow shape occupies the left and bottom portions. A teal shape is in the top right corner. A light beige shape is in the bottom right corner, partially overlapping the yellow and teal shapes.



CLASS OF SERVICE DESIRED	
Fast Day Message	☒
Day Letter	☐
Night Message	☐
Night Letter	☐

Patrons should mark an X opposite the class of service desired; OTHERWISE THE TELEGRAM WILL BE TRANSMITTED AS A FAST DAY MESSAGE.

WESTERN UNION TELEGRAM

NEWCOMB CARLTON, PRESIDENT

Receiving No.	3300
Check	
Time Filed	

Send the following telegram, subject to the terms on back hereof, which are hereby agreed to

via Galveston

JAN 18 1917

GERMAN LEGATION

MEXICO CITY

130	13042	13401	8501	115	3528	416	17214	6491	11310
18147	18222	21560	10247	11518	23677	13605	3494	14936	
98092	5905	11311	10392	10371	0302	21290	5161	39695	
23571	17504	11289	18276	18101	0317	0228	17694	4473	
22284	22200	19452	21589	67893	5569	13918	8958	12137	
1333	4725	4458	5905	17166	13851	4458	17149	14471	6706
13850	12224	6929	14991	7382	15857	67893	14218	36477	
5870	17553	67893	5870	5454	16102	15217	22801	17138	
21001	17388	7446	23638	18222	6719	14331	15021	23845	
3156	23552	22096	21604	4797	9497	22464	20855	4377	
23610	18140	22260	5905	13347	20420	39689	13732	20667	
6929	5275	18507	52262	1340	22049	13339	11265	22295	
10439	14814	4178	6992	8784	7632	7357	6926	52262	11267
21100	21272	9346	9559	22464	15874	18502	18500	15857	
2188	5376	7381	98092	16127	13486	9350	9220	76036	14219
5144	2831	17920	11347	17142	11264	7667	7762	15099	9110
10482	97556	3569	3670						

BEPNSTOPFF.

Charge German Embassy.

3 Cols Sunday Cartoon



Major Events and Developments in the War

1918

- January 1918 – President Wilson presents his 14 Points to Congress
- March 1918 – Germany begins its final offensive of the war
 - Same month, American women are sent to Europe as telephone operators
- June 1918 – Americans stop German advances at the Marne River
- September 1918 – Allies begin final offensive at Meuse-Argonne
- November 11, 1918 – Germany signs an armistice to end the war



Ending the War

From Left to Right:

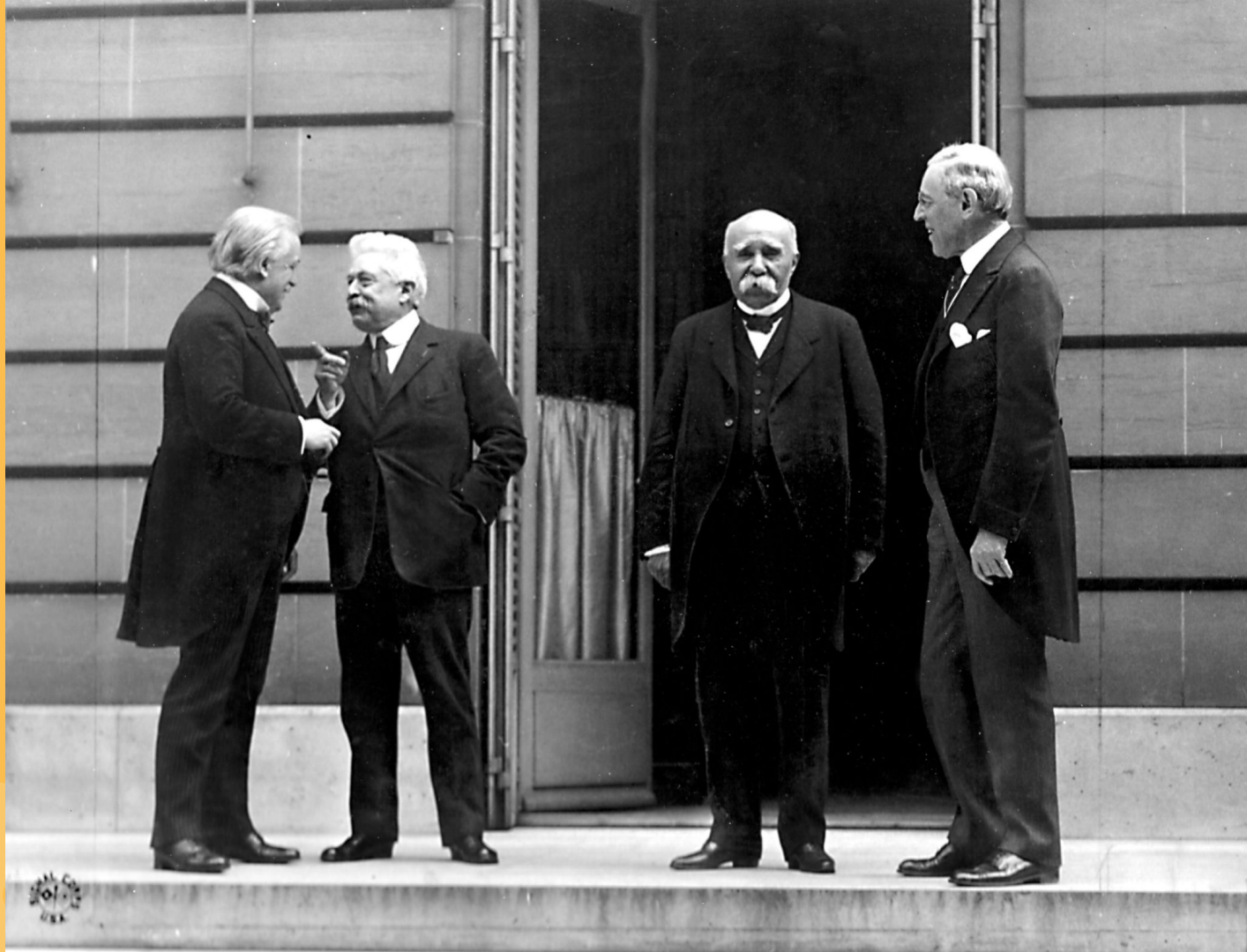
David Lloyd George of
England

Vittorio Orlando of Italy

Georges Clemenceau of
France

Woodrow Wilson of the
United States

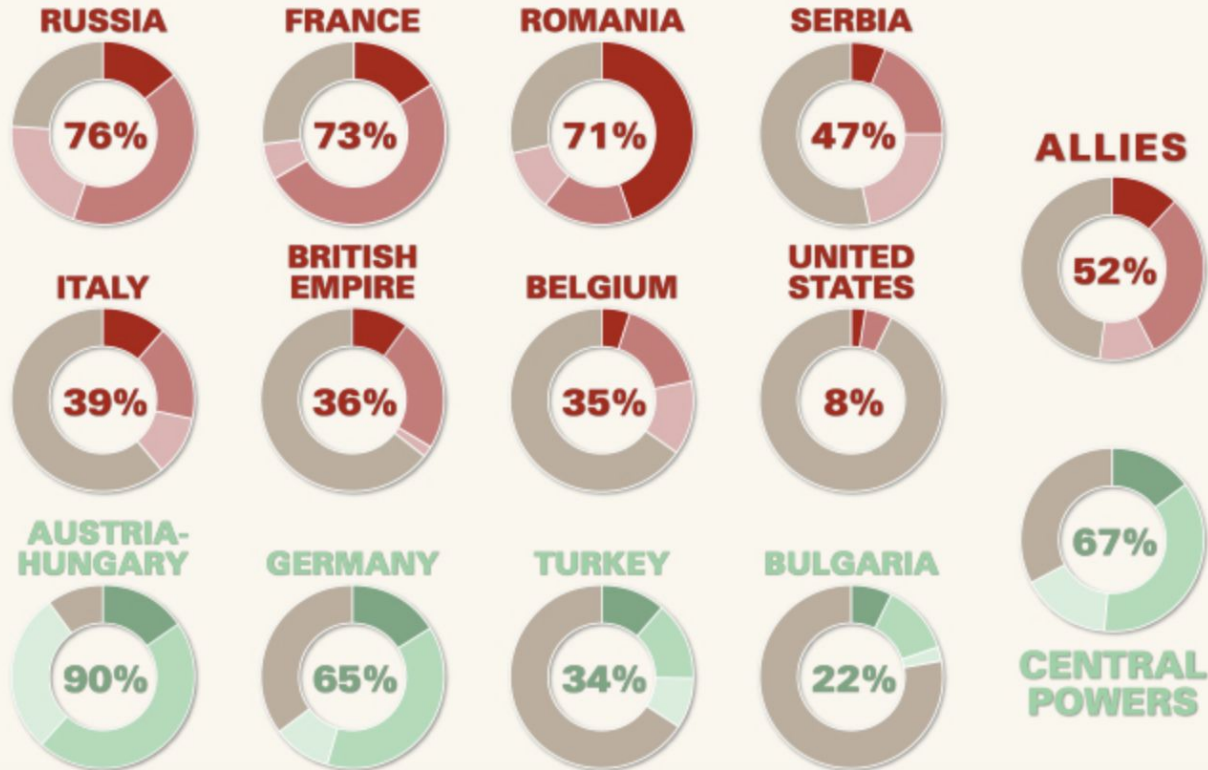
Leaders meet in
Versailles to discuss
plans to end the war
and to create peace in
Europe



CASUALTIES OF MAJOR COUNTRIES INVOLVED

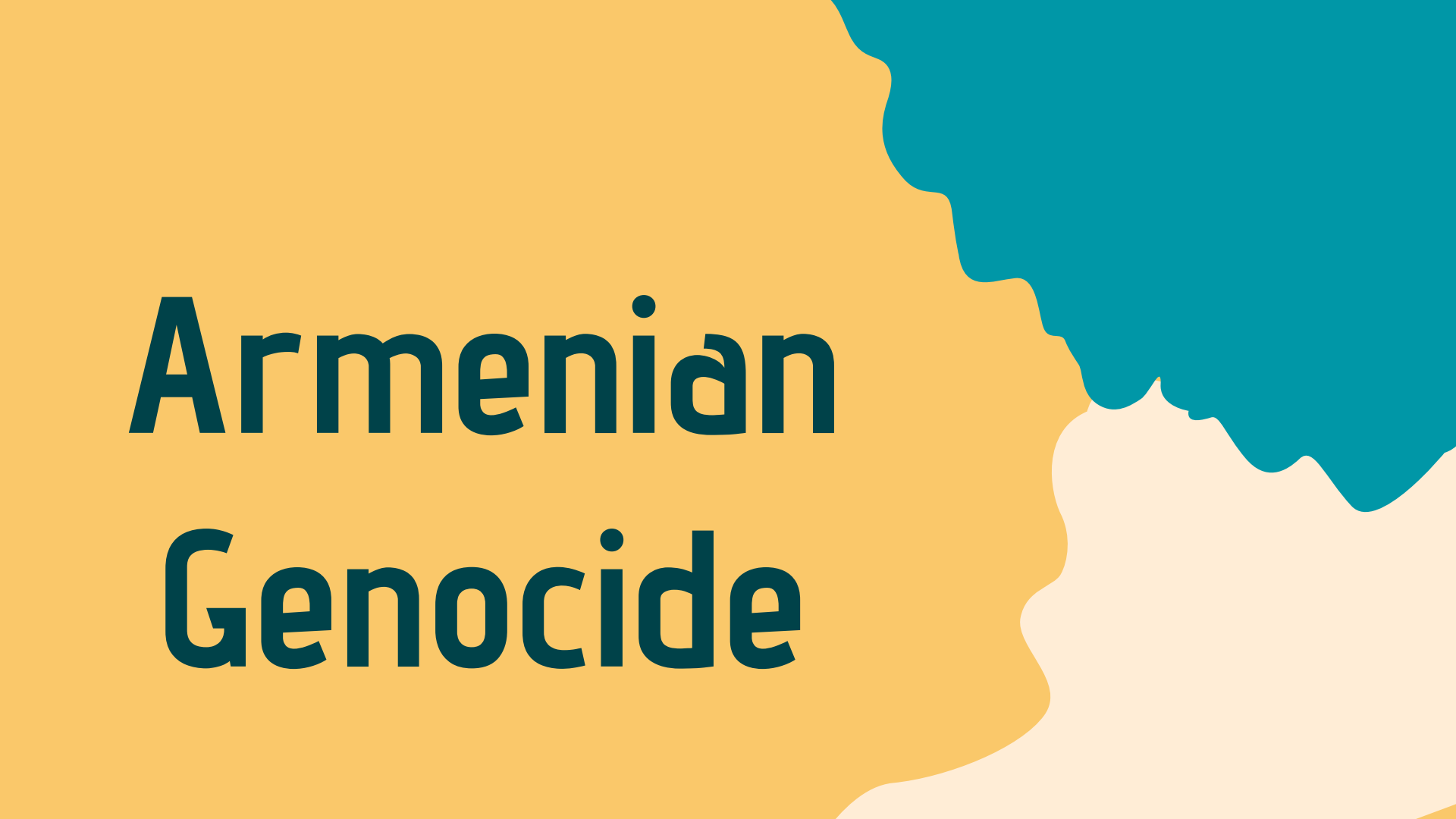
■ Killed/died
 ■ Wounded
 ■ Prisoners/missing
 ■ Mobilized forces

76% / 90% Percentage of mobilized forces that became casualties*



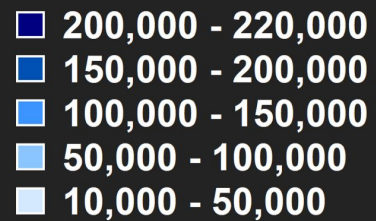
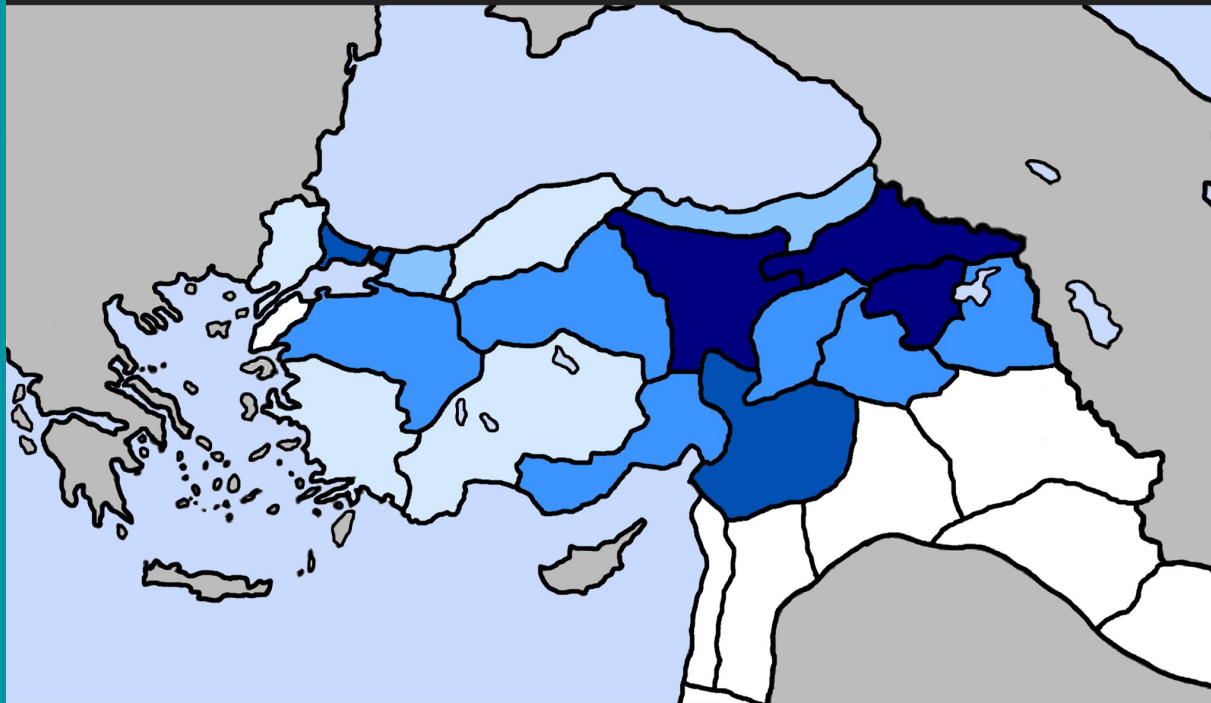
*Total casualties = killed/died + wounded + prisoners/missing.

Armenian Genocide

The background features abstract, organic shapes. A large yellow shape occupies the left and bottom portions. A teal shape is in the top right corner. A light beige shape is in the bottom right corner, partially overlapping the yellow and teal shapes.



Armenian Population in the Ottoman Empire 1913 - 1914



Settlements: 2925

Churches: 2538

Monasteries: 451

Schools: 1996

Total: 1,914,620

Based on the records of the Armenian Patriarchate of Constantinople



The Armenian Genocide

1915: main massacres, deportation and flight routes

